

Types of Cyber Incidents

Type 5	• Loss of life directly attributable to the cyber incident. • Community Lifelines non-functional (Safety and Security; Food, Water, Shelter; Health and Medical; Energy; Communications; Transportation; Hazardous Materials) • Essential services non-functional (Dispatch Centers, Fire/EMS services, etc.) • Financial impacts exceed the organizational capabilities. (Ransom/Replacement costs exceeds the organizations budget) • Confirmed exposure records of Personal Information • Services critical for payment and financial processing non-functional
Type 4	• Community Lifelines impacted and minimally operational (Safety and Security; Food, Water, Shelter; Health and Medical; Energy; Communications; Transportation; Hazardous Materials) • Essential services impacted and minimally operational (Dispatch Centers, Fire/EMS services, etc.) • Financial impacts are close to meeting the organizational capabilities. (Ransom/Replacement costs exceeds the organizations budget) • Suspected records of Personal Information exposed • Services critical for payment and financial processing impacted and are minimally operational
Type 3	• Community Lifelines impacted and partial operational (Safety and Security; Food, Water, Shelter; Health and Medical; Energy; Communications; Transportation; Hazardous Materials) • Essential services impacted and partially operational (Dispatch Centers, Fire/EMS services, etc.) • Financial impacts are close to meeting the organizational capabilities. (Ransom/Replacement costs exceeds the organizations budget) • Potential Personal Information exposed • Services critical for payment and financial processing impacted and partially operational

- Type 2
- Community Lifelines impacted and mostly operational
(Safety and Security; Food, Water, Shelter; Health and Medical;
Energy; Communications; Transportation; Hazardous Materials)
 - Essential services impacted and mostly operational
(Dispatch Centers, Fire/EMS services, etc.)
 - Financial impacts are close to meeting the organizational capabilities.
(Ransom/Replacement costs exceeds the organizations budget)
 - Potential Personal Information exposed
 - Services critical for payment and financial processing impacted and mostly operational

- Type 1
- Community Lifelines are not impacted and are completely operational
(Safety and Security; Food, Water, Shelter; Health and Medical;
Energy; Communications; Transportation; Hazardous Materials)
 - Essential services are not impacted and are completely operational
(Dispatch Centers, Fire/EMS services, etc.)
 - Financial impacts are minimum.
 - (Ransom/Replacement costs exceeds the organizations budget)
 - Little to no belief of exposure records of Personal Information exposed
 - Services critical for payment and financial processing are not impacted and are completely operational

Cybersecurity Incident

A cybersecurity incident (or simply incident) is ...an occurrence that actually or imminently jeopardizes, without lawful authority, the integrity, confidentiality, or availability of information or an information system; or constitutes a violation or imminent threat of violation of law, security policies, security procedures, or acceptable use policies. [FISMA2014]

Cyber Incident Severity Schema

The United States Federal Cybersecurity Centers, in coordination with departments and agencies with cybersecurity or cyber operations mission, adopted a common schema for describing the severity of cyber incidents affecting the homeland, U.S. capabilities, or U.S. interests. The schema establishes a common framework for evaluating and assessing cyber incidents to ensure that all departments and

agencies have a common view of the:

- The severity of a given incident;
- The urgency required for responding to a given incident;
- The seniority level necessary for coordinating response efforts; and
- The level of investment required of response efforts.

The table below depicts several key elements of the schema.

	General Definition	Observed Actions	Intended Consequence ¹
Level 5 <i>Emergency</i> (Black)	<i>Poses an imminent threat to the provision of wide-scale critical infrastructure services, national gov't stability, or to the lives of U.S. persons.</i>	Effect	Cause physical consequence
Level 4 <i>Severe</i> (Red)	<i>Likely to result in a significant impact to public health or safety, national security, economic security, foreign relations, or civil liberties.</i>	Presence	Damage computer and networking hardware
Level 3 <i>High</i> (Orange)	<i>Likely to result in a demonstrable impact to public health or safety, national security, economic security, foreign relations, civil liberties, or public confidence.</i>		Corrupt or destroy data Deny availability to a key system or service
Level 2 <i>Medium</i> (Yellow)	<i>May impact public health or safety, national security, economic security, foreign relations, civil liberties, or public confidence.</i>	Engagement	Steal sensitive information
Level 1 <i>Low</i> (Green)	<i>Unlikely to impact public health or safety, national security, economic security, foreign relations, civil liberties, or public confidence.</i>	Preparation	Commit a financial crime
Level 0 <i>Baseline</i> (White)	Unsubstantiated or inconsequential event.		Nuisance DoS or defacement